■ THE DAILY GOODS STORY SCOUT - Friday, August 14, 2026

TODAY'S RUNDOWN SLOTS

THE LIST (3 stories)

🛩■ *Trump's secret plane switch was about Iranian missile threat*

The Angle: *A cloak-and-dagger moment at the White House: Trump ditched Air Force One for another plane after U.S. and Turkish intelligence caught wind of a credible Iranian plot to shoot it down. The timing—within 24 hours—raises hard questions about how real the threat was and what the public should know.*

- **Trump secretly switched from Air Force One to another plane using a catering truck** to move between aircraft undetected
- The switch happened **within a day of U.S. and Turkish intelligence picking up on a credible Iranian plot to fire a missile** at Air Force One
- The elaborate security ruse involved coordination between American and Turkish intelligence agencies to detect the threat

The National Security Question

- Should the public have been told about a credible assassination plot against a sitting president—or does keeping it quiet actually save lives?

CBS News (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 81/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 24 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbsnews.com/news/trump-secret-air-force-one-switch-iran-missile-threat/

■ *Feds allegedly spied on left-wing groups and ICE protesters*

The Angle: *Documents reveal the U.S. government conducted large-scale surveillance on domestic protest movements—raising major questions about government overreach, civil liberties, and what "counterintelligence" actually covers. This is the kind of story that cuts across the political spectrum when the shoe's on the other foot.*

- Reports indicate a **'mass spying campaign'** targeting **leftwing activist groups** and anti-ICE protesters
- Details emerged through **records releases**, suggesting government surveillance programs went wider than previously disclosed
- The revelations raise concerns about **First Amendment protections** and monitoring of domestic political speech

The Trust Question

- If your own government monitored your political protests without a warrant, would that change how you think about surveillance laws—even if you disagree with the protesters?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.theguardian.com/us-news/2026/aug/13/us-government-spied-anti-ice-protesters

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■ *California teens ditching college for trade school—here's why*

The Angle: *As tuition skyrockets and AI threatens office jobs, young Californians are flipping the script: they're choosing plumbing, electrical work, and construction over four-year degrees. It's a real shift in how the next generation thinks about earning and job security.*

- Fears about **AI disrupting white-collar jobs** are pushing more young Californians toward skilled trades
- Teens are choosing **apprenticeships and vocational training** over traditional college paths
- The shift reflects concerns about **rising tuition costs** making college increasingly out of reach

The Reality Check

- Is sending your kid to a four-year university still the right move, or are we finally admitting the deck's stacked against them?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN
- **Step 1: The Cost Comparison** - Quick on-air math -> Hosts riff on the actual numbers: four-year degree debt vs. apprenticeship earnings timeline—what's the real ROI?
- **Step 2: The AI Wild Card** - Future-proofing take -> Debate: Will a skilled trades job be safer from automation than a desk job in 10 years?
- **Step 3: Caller Poll** - Open phones -> Ask listeners: if you had a teen right now, would you steer them toward trades or college? Why?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/08/14/us-news/california-teens-shift-to-trade-schools-as-college-tuition-skyrockets/

ENTERTAINMENT (4 stories)

■ *Actor Dylan Walsh spoils his own show, pays the price*

The Angle: *A star from the hit hockey drama 'Heated Rivalry' accidentally (or not?) dropped major plot details in a viral Cameo video—and the studio is not happy. It's a cautionary tale about what happens when cast members go rogue on social media.*

- **Dylan Walsh** plays **David Hollander** on the hit hockey drama **'Heated Rivalry'**
- Walsh revealed **upcoming episode details** in a **Cameo video clip** that went viral
- The actor is now **'in trouble'** with the show's producers over the leak

The Spoiler Showdown
- Should networks cut actors some slack for fan interactions, or is spoiling your own show a fireable offense?

Variety (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/tv/news/heated-rivalry-dylan-walsh-cameo-1236833640/

■ *Matthew McConaughey's Secret Movie Finally Hits Theaters*

The Angle: *McConaughey's making a comeback in what critics are calling one of the year's best films—but almost nobody knows it exists yet. This is the stealth-release story that has Hollywood buzzing right now.*

- **Matthew McConaughey** is returning to the big screen in a new film
- The movie is arriving in **theaters nationwide** imminently
- It's being described as **one of the best movies of the year** by critics
- The film has had virtually **no mainstream awareness or marketing buzz** despite the acclaim

The Discovery Moment
- Have you caught wind of this McConaughey film, or is this the first you're hearing about it—and does a stealth-release actually make you MORE curious to see something?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN
- **Step 1: The Mystery Setup** - First 30 seconds -> Host A asks Host B: 'How is a Matthew McConaughey movie that critics are calling one of the year's BEST films basically invisible?' Tease the disconnect.
- **Step 2: The Hype Flip** - Next 60 seconds -> Host B plays devil's advocate: 'Maybe word-of-mouth is worth more than a $50 million ad spend. Maybe studios are done screaming at us.' Explore the anti-marketing angle.
- **Step 3: The Call-In** - Live segment -> Ask listeners: 'Have you seen it or heard about it? And does a movie being a secret actually make you want to hunt it down?' Take calls.

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://decider.com/2026/08/14/the-rivals-of-amziah-king-review/

■ *Anne Hathaway's new film—theater or stream?*

The Angle: *Anne Hathaway's back on the big screen this summer, and there's a real question brewing about whether her latest project is worth the multiplex ticket or if you can just wait for it to hit your couch. It's the kind of trade-off conversation audiences are having constantly right now.*

- **Anne Hathaway** is starring in a new film titled **'The End of Oak Street'**
- The film is releasing this summer at movie theaters
- The story frames a debate about theater vs. streaming viewing experience for this particular release

The Big-Screen Verdict

- Do you still go to theaters for specific actors, or has streaming basically killed that habit for you?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: The Theater Case** - 60 seconds -> Host One makes the pitch for why this movie *needs* the multiplex experience—cinematography, sound, the vibe—without spoilers.
- **Step 2: The Streaming Case** - 60 seconds -> Host Two counters with the practical reality: cost, convenience, family-friendly flexibility at home.
- **Step 3: The Call** - 2-3 minutes -> Open phones: *What movie would actually get you back to a theater right now, and what's your honest streaming threshold?*

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://decider.com/2026/08/14/the-end-of-oak-street-review/

■ *Shanna Moakler takes a shot at Kourtney Kardashian on the red carpet*

The Angle: *Travis Barker's ex-girlfriend and Kourtney Kardashian's ongoing feud just got a fresh public airing at a documentary premiere—the kind of celebrity beef that keeps the internet talking and raises questions about blended-family drama playing out in the spotlight.*

- The clash happened at the **"Travis Barker: Louder Than Fear" documentary premiere**
- **Shanna Moakler**, **Travis Barker's ex**, made a **"savage red carpet comment"** directed at **Kourtney Kardashian**
- **Kourtney** attended with her husband and **three children she shares with Barker**

The Blended-Family Reality Check

- Is it ever okay to air relationship drama publicly when kids are involved, or is this just how celebrity exes roll?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://pagesix.com/2026/08/14/entertainment/travis-barkers-ex-shanna-moakler-revives-kourtney-kardashian-feud-with-red-carpet-comment/

Backup options:

■ *McConaughey's cash cow: which film keeps paying him*

The Angle: *Matthew McConaughey just revealed which movie is basically his personal ATM—and it's probably not the one you'd guess. He called it 'the gift that keeps on giving,' and we're finding out which film has made him the most money in residuals by a landslide.*

- **Matthew McConaughey** revealed one film generates his residuals **'by far'** more than any other
- He described the movie as **'the gift that keeps on giving'**—suggesting it's still paying him regularly decades later

The Guess-the-Movie Moment

- Before we tell you which film it is—what's your guess? Which McConaughey movie do you think made him the most money in the long run?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: Host Predictions** - 30 seconds -> Each host names which McConaughey film they think is his residual goldmine—go with your gut, no research allowed
- **Step 2: Call In Your Guesses** - 2-3 minutes -> Open the phones: listeners text/call in which McConaughey movie they think is paying him the most—points if you nail it before the reveal
- **Step 3: The Reveal & Hot Take** - 1-2 minutes -> Drop which film it actually is, then ask: does that surprise you? Why do you think *that* one keeps making money?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://pagesix.com/2026/08/14/entertainment/matthew-mcconaughey-reveals-which-movie-makes-him-most-residuals-by-far/

■ *New shows drop this weekend—here's what to stream*

The Angle: *HBO's 'Lanterns' kicks off a fresh batch of weekend viewing options across all the major platforms. Whether you're into superhero stuff, nostalgia, or something lighter, there's something landing right now worth your attention.*

- **'Lanterns'** series premiere lands on **HBO Max** this weekend
- **'Don't Say Good Luck'** hits **Netflix**
- **'Camp Rock 3'** drops on **Disney+**

The Streaming Showdown

- What's on your watch list this weekend—and are you actually keeping up with all these streaming services, or is it getting out of hand?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://decider.com/2026/08/14/best-new-movies-shows-weekend-netflix-hulu-amazon-prime-hbo-august-14-2026/

■ *Writer turns cancer and theater into Netflix movie with Adam Sandler*

The Angle: *Laura Hankin adapted her own story—getting a lead role in her school musical while her mom battled terminal cancer—into a new Netflix film. It's a real-life collision of joy and heartbreak that became a Sandler-backed project, and it's sparking conversations about how we process grief through art.*

- **Laura Hankin** wrote and developed a story based on her real experience as a junior who landed the lead in her school's musical while her **mother was dying of terminal cancer**
- The project became a Netflix film with **Adam Sandler's** production company involved
- The film is titled **'Don't Say Good Luck'**, pulling from theater superstition language

The Vulnerability Angle

- Have you ever had to perform or show up for something huge while dealing with a personal crisis at home—and did it help or hurt?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: The Setup** - 30 seconds -> Host A lays out Hankin's story: lead role, same moment, mom's diagnosis. Host B reacts to the timing collision.
- **Step 2: The 'Theater Superstition' Callback** - 20 seconds -> Hosts riff on the title—'Don't Say Good Luck'—and joke about whether that superstition actually helped her cope or just made it weirder.
- **Step 3: The Real Question** - open-ended -> Invite callers: Did performing or creating something help you through grief, or did it feel impossible to focus?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://decider.com/2026/08/14/netflix-dont-say-good-luck-true-story-laura-hankin-writer-interview-sunny-sandler-movie/

■ *Jenna Jameson marries for the fourth time in a year*

The Angle: *The former adult film star just said 'I do' again—this time to **Mil R. Ocampo** after barely a year of dating. It's her fourth marriage, and she didn't waste any time after her last divorce. Classic tabloid lightning-round romance that's got everyone asking: what's the rush?*

- **Jenna Jameson** married **Mil R. Ocampo** on **July 25** in an intimate ceremony in **Miami**
- The couple dated for roughly **one year** before tying the knot
- This is **Jameson's fourth marriage**
- She hard-launched the romance with Ocampo just weeks after her previous divorce

The Pattern Play

- Fourth wedding in one year of dating—is this a love story or a love *speed-run*? What's your take on the quick turnaround?

Page Six (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL:
https://pagesix.com/2026/08/13/celebrity-news/jenna-jameson-gets-married-for-the-fourth-time-weds-mil-r-ocampo-after-1-year-of-dating/

TRENDING TODAY

(no candidate scored high enough today)

LIFESTYLE CHAT

■ *Skip the long run—sprinting might be the real fitness shortcut*

The Angle: *New research suggests a few minutes of all-out sprinting could deliver bigger metabolic benefits than nearly two hours of steady jogging. It's the kind of science that makes couch potatoes perk up—and challenges everything we thought we knew about cardio.*

- **Sprinting triggers changes in more than 200 metabolites** in the body
- Sprint workouts cause an **immediate surge of proteins involved in blood-vessel growth, tissue remodeling, and hormonal signaling**
- The metabolic impact of a short sprint outperforms **90 minutes of moderate running**

The Plot Twist

- Are you spending way too much time on the treadmill when you could get better results in five minutes of all-out effort?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: The Confession Round** - First two minutes -> Hosts admit their own cardio habits—long slow runs, elliptical slog sessions, whatever they actually do—and react to the idea that they might've been doing it wrong the whole time
- **Step 2: The Science Breakdown** - Next two minutes -> Hosts translate the 200 metabolites and protein surge into plain English: what does that actually *feel* like in your body, and why does it matter for real people trying to get fit
- **Step 3: The Challenge Setup** - Final minute -> Hosts throw it to listeners: who's willing to ditch their 90-minute routine this week and try a sprint day instead—call in and report back tomorrow on whether they actually feel the difference

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.eurekalert.org/news-releases/1139915

Backup options:

■ *Your brain is way smarter than we thought it was*

The Angle: *Neuroscientists just realized they've been underestimating how much computing power a single brain cell actually has. Turns out each neuron can handle multiple calculations simultaneously—which could totally reframe how we understand human cognition and AI development.*

- **Scientists have vastly underestimated** the computational power of individual neurons
- Each neuron has **hundreds of sprawling branches** that enable parallel processing
- A single neuron can **perform multiple computations simultaneously**, not just one at a time
- This discovery reshapes understanding of **how the brain processes information** at the cellular level

The Mind-Bender

- If your brain's been operating at way higher capacity than we thought, what does that say about human potential—and does it change how we should be thinking about artificial intelligence?

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.scientificamerican.com/article/neuroscientists-have-vastly-underestimated-brain-cells-computing-power/

■ *Weight-loss drug tied to lower dementia risk in new study*

The Angle: *Semaglutide—the drug behind Ozempic and Wegovy that everyone's talking about for weight loss—might have a bonus benefit: it could reduce your dementia risk by as much as 26% over five years, according to new research. That's huge if it holds up, and it's sparking real conversation about whether this drug's reach goes way beyond metabolism.*

- **Semaglutide** is linked to a **26% lower 5-year predicted dementia risk** in new study findings
- The drug is widely known as **Ozempic** (diabetes) and **Wegovy** (weight loss), making it one of the most talked-about medications in North America right now
- This research suggests potential cognitive and neurological benefits beyond the drug's primary uses for blood sugar and appetite control

The Hot Take

- If this holds up, does that change how you think about semaglutide—or does it feel too good to be true?

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://alz-journals.onlinelibrary.wiley.com/doi/10.1002/dad2.70432

CLOSER: THE KICKER/GOODBYES (franchise fallback)

■ *Boat Captain's Foghorn Wake-Up Call Costs Him Five Grand*

The Angle: *A Canadian boat operator learned an expensive lesson about wildlife protection when he used a foghorn to rouse a napping polar bear—and wildlife officials weren't amused. It's the kind of 'seemed like a good idea at the time' story that lands perfectly as a show closer.*

- A boat operator was **fined over $5,000** for using a **foghorn to wake a sleeping polar bear**
- The incident appears to have violated **wildlife protection regulations** in what is likely a Canadian Arctic region
- The story surfaced on **Reddit's r/nottheonion**, a subreddit for real news that sounds too absurd to be true

The Listener Verdict

- Would you ever do something this wild for a photo op, or is the polar bear's right to sleep the real issue here?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbsnews.com/news/sleeping-polar-bear-woken-foghorn-fine-arctic/

Backup options:

■■ *Texas guy gets jailed for dropping the F-bomb at city hall*

The Angle: *A man was actually arrested and detained for swearing during public comment at a municipal meeting—raising immediate questions about free speech, municipal overreach, and what the hell happened in that room. It's absurd on its face, but it's sparking real debate about where the line is.*

- A **Texas man** was **jailed** for swearing during public comment at a public meeting
- The charge hinges on disruption or contempt of a public proceeding—exact charges depend on local statute
- Public comment periods are supposed to be protected speech, making this arrest legally questionable to First Amendment advocates

The Rant Trigger

- Have you ever wanted to tell someone off in an official setting—and if so, how much trouble would you actually be in?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.chron.com/texas/article/tarrant-county-commisioners-court-arrest-22385573.php

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FLEX (cap check: THE GREAT DEBATE 1/4 this month; TECH TALK 3/3 this month; Advice/Relationship Cluster 3/3 this month)

■ *AI Stethoscope Bombs at Diagnosing Cat Heart Disease*

The Angle: *A popular AI tool trained on human hearts completely whiffed when tested on pets—missing most cat murmurs and falsely flagging healthy dogs. It's a reality check on how AI tools can fail outside their training wheelhouse, and a reminder that not all AI hype translates to the real world.*

- The AI stethoscope missed **20 of 22 cat murmurs** in testing
- The tool also incorrectly flagged **healthy dogs with atrial fibrillation** they didn't actually have
- The device was originally built and trained to diagnose **human heart conditions**

The Reality Check

- If an AI stethoscope can't hear what a cat's heart is doing, what other AI tools are we trusting that might be totally off base in ways we don't realize?

studyfinds.com (Tier 3) | Score: 32/90 (12 fit + 4 source + 16 quality) -> BACKUP

URL: https://studyfinds.com/popular-ai-stethoscope-flunks-pet-heart-test-missing-20-of-22-cat-murmurs/

ADDITIONAL CANDIDATES (no specific segment match, but scored well on source/quality - producer's call on where these fit)

■ *British election gets weird: Farage runs against a literal Count*

The Angle: *A UK special election just became peak British absurdism—far-right politician Nigel Farage is facing off against "Count Binface," a character candidate in a race that's already being written off as a publicity stunt. It's the kind of real-world oddity that feels too silly to be true.*

- **Nigel Farage**, a major figure in British politics, is running in a special election
- His opponent is **Count Binface**, a character/performance artist candidate
- The race has been **denounced as a stunt** by critics
- This is a special (non-routine) UK election

The Absurdity Check

- Is a literal novelty-character candidate actually the move when you're tired of taking politics seriously, or is this just British politics finally breaking?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL:
https://www.pbs.org/newshour/politics/nigel-farage-faces-off-against-count-binface-in-special-election-thats-been-denounced-as-a-stunt

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■ *Gen Z is betting their retirement funds on sports*

The Angle: *A wild financial decision is making the rounds: young people are allegedly pulling retirement savings and throwing it at sports bets instead. It's funny on the surface, but it's also a peek at how a generation is thinking about money and risk in a very different way.*

- Survey reports **Gen Z** is redirecting **retirement savings** into **sports betting**
- The story emerged on **Reddit's r/nottheonion** community, typically flagged for absurd-but-true stories

The Reality Check

- If you're Gen Z or you've got Gen Z in your life—are you actually seeing this play out, or is this internet hyperbole?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://thedeepdive.ca/gen-z-redirects-retirement-savings-into-sports-betting-survey-finds/

■ *Drug researchers ID hallucinogenic mushroom with bizarre side effect*

The Angle: *Scientists studying psychoactive mushrooms have documented a strain that triggers a wildly specific visual hallucination—users report seeing hundreds of tiny people. It's the kind of weirdly specific phenomenon that makes you wonder what's actually going on in the brain during these experiences.*

- Research focuses on a hallucinogenic mushroom species that produces an unusual and consistent hallucination pattern
- Users report seeing **hundreds of tiny people** as a primary visual effect during the trip
- The specificity of the hallucination across different users suggests something neurologically distinct about this particular strain

The Curiosity Grab

- If you've ever wondered what your brain is actually *doing* when it hallucinates the exact same tiny people as a stranger across the country—this is the story that makes you ask that question.

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: The Setup** - 30 seconds -> Host A introduces: 'Scientists just documented something genuinely bizarre about one hallucinogenic mushroom—and it's oddly specific.' Host B jumps in curious.
- **Step 2: The Reveal** - 45 seconds -> Host A drops the detail: people on this mushroom see *hundreds of tiny people*—same hallucination, different users. Host B reacts with disbelief/fascination.
- **Step 3: The Brain Bend** - 1 minute -> Hosts riff on why that's so strange—if dozens of people all see the *same* tiny people, is the mushroom unlocking something real in how the brain works, or is it just a glitch? Open it up as a genuine 'what does this mean?' moment.

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nhmu.utah.edu/articles/hallucinogenic-mushroom-makes-you-see-hundreds-tiny-people

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■ *Bumble divides users by ditching its signature 'women-first' chat rule*

The Angle: *Bumble divides users by ditching its signature 'women-first' chat rule*

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.bbc.com/news/articles/cvglzlj81x2o

■■ *The world’s most efficient solar panel goes on sale later this year*

The Angle: *The world’s most efficient solar panel goes on sale later this year*

Reddit r/futurology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://pv-magazine-usa.com/2026/08/13/the-worlds-most-efficient-solar-panel-goes-on-sale-later-this-year/

■■ *Why Americans are ditching their political parties*

The Angle: *It's not about hiding anymore—growing numbers of independents say they're genuinely fed up with their own side. This shift tells us something real about how fractured American politics actually feels right now.*

- **Rising number of Americans** now identify as **political independents**
- The shift is **driven by genuine dissatisfaction with their own preferred party**, not a desire to avoid social judgment
- **Real frustration with American politics** is the core driver, not performative distancing

The Reality Check

- Are you independent because you switched sides, or because you're just tired of the whole game? Call in and tell us where you stand.

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.psypost.org/frustration-not-fear-of-judgment-drives-the-rise-of-independent-voters/

■■■ *Jon Hamm's old 'terrible father' quote haunts him on baby news*

The Angle: *The actor spent years saying he wasn't cut out for parenthood—then broke up with his longtime partner Jennifer Westfeldt and just got engaged to a much younger woman who's now pregnant. Cue the internet reminding him of every quote he ever made about not wanting kids.*

- **Jon Hamm** is set to become a dad at **55 years old**

- He was previously in an **18-year relationship with Jennifer Westfeldt**, during which he repeatedly said he'd be a **'terrible father'**
- The resurfaced quotes are now circulating as he's engaged to a younger partner and expecting a child

The Life-Plan Plot Twist

- How many of you have said 'I'm never doing that' and then completely changed your mind later—and how awkward was it when people brought it up?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: The Quote Recall** - Opening bit -> Hosts riff on which famous celebrity "never again" statements have aged the worst—the times someone swore off something and then did it anyway
- **Step 2: Life-Plan Flip** - Audience call-in -> Take calls from listeners who've completely reversed a major life stance (kids, marriage, career pivot, moving back home) and ask what changed their mind
- **Step 3: The Hamm Angle** - Closer -> Circle back to whether major life changes (new relationship, different partner) actually do justify eating your words, or if he deserves the roasting

pagesix.com (Tier 2) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 25 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://pagesix.com/2026/08/13/celebrity-news/jon-hamm-once-said-hed-be-a-terrible-father-in-resurfaced-interview/

■ *Brad Pitt's Sobriety Slip Gets Real Talk From Addiction Experts*

The Angle: *Brad Pitt just revealed he's drinking again after seven years sober—and recovery experts say his experience is way more common than people think, but also way more complicated than a simple headline makes it sound.*

- **Brad Pitt** admitted to consuming alcohol again after **7 years sober** and **18 months in AA**
- Addiction experts note that relapse is **common** in recovery and doesn't necessarily signal failure
- One key quote from recovery community: **"Alcoholics are a horrible source of information about themselves"**—meaning self-reporting sobriety status is often unreliable
- The reaction has been strong within the recovery community, with mixed takes on what his public disclosure means

The Reality Check

- If one of Hollywood's biggest names can't stay sober, what does that tell us about how we talk about addiction and recovery?

Hollywood Reporter (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: http://www.hollywoodreporter.com/movies/movie-news/brad-pitt-drinking-again-experts-react-1236671246/

■ *Travis Barker opens up in raw new Hulu doc*

The Angle: *The Blink-182 drummer gets unusually candid about his plane crash trauma, his relationship with Kourtney Kardashian, and personal struggles in a major new documentary that's already generating headlines. It's the kind of deep-dive celebrity doc that sparks real conversations beyond the fanbase.*

- **Travis Barker** stars in **'Travis Barker: Louder Than Fear,'** a new **Hulu documentary** streaming now
- The doc covers his **near-fatal plane crash** and the trauma that followed
- The film includes intimate details about his relationship with **Kourtney Kardashian,** including her **miscarriage**
- **Taylor Hawkins,** the late Foo Fighters drummer, makes a **surprise cameo** in the documentary

The Overshare Question

- How much do you want to know about a celebrity's personal pain—and does dropping it all in a doc feel like healing or just content?

Page Six (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://pagesix.com/2026/08/13/entertainment/biggest-revelations-from-travis-barker-louder-than-fear-doc-kourtney-kardashian-miscarriage-and-more/

■ *Home battery boom keeps rolling—tax credits or not*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Home battery installations climbing despite federal incentive loss signals genuine consumer demand shift that contradicts expected market behavior and suggests a durable trend.
The Angle: *People are installing residential battery systems in record numbers even after the federal tax incentive expired, suggesting the technology has finally hit a real tipping point with homeowners. It's a genuinely optimistic story about people doubling down on energy independence.*

- Home battery installations are **climbing despite the loss of federal incentives** that previously subsidized the purchases
- The trend suggests **residential energy storage has moved from subsidy-dependent to self-sustaining demand**
- Homeowners are investing in battery systems for **backup power, energy independence, and lower electricity bills**

The Feel-Good Closer

- Do you have solar or a home battery system, or would you actually make that investment if you had the money?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.canarymedia.com/articles/energy-storage/home-battery-installations-climb

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■ *Russia wants to test AI on traditional values*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Russia's AI 'traditional values' testing is a rare geopolitical AI story with immediate policy implications and satirical/absurdist appeal that could resonate across audiences.
The Angle: *Russia is moving to certify AI models based on whether they align with 'traditional values'—a move that highlights how different countries are trying to shape AI development to match their political ideologies, and raises real questions about who gets to decide what's acceptable AI behavior worldwide.*

- **Russia** is planning to test and certify AI models against standards of **'traditional values'**
- The move reflects a broader pattern of nations trying to steer AI development toward their own political and cultural frameworks
- This approach could create competing global standards for AI, fragmenting how the technology operates across borders

The Weird-But-Real Moment

- If Russia gets to test AI for 'traditional values,' what happens when every country wants to certify AI differently—and whose AI rules win?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://moscowmonitor.com/292/russia-to-test-ai-models-against-traditional-values-for-national-status/

■ *NASA just found rubies and sapphires on Mars*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): NASA Perseverance finding gemstone minerals on Mars has high novelty factor and NASA credibility that tends to drive sustained secondary engagement even from low starts.
The Angle: *Perseverance rover uncovered chromium-bearing corundum in Martian rocks—the same mineral that forms precious gemstones here on Earth. It's a wild reminder that Mars is geologically way more complex than we thought, and it could tell us something new about how the planet evolved.*

- **NASA's Perseverance rover** detected **chromium-bearing corundum** in Martian rocks
- This is the **first evidence** of the gemstone-forming mineral on Mars
- The same mineral (**corundum**) forms **rubies and sapphires** on Earth

The Wonder Moment

- If we ever colonize Mars, does that mean we're sitting on a planet full of untapped gemstones—and does that even matter when we're trying to survive there?

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.sciencealert.com/very-unexpected-nasa-rover-zapped-a-rock-on-mars-and-found-a-gemstone-surprise

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BREAKOUT WATCH (below the show's usual engagement bar - included on editorial judgment, not metrics; producer's call)

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■ *Oblivion Remastered Switch 2 sold out on release date, showing appeal of physical games*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Oblivion Switch 2 instant sellout taps into growing physical games resurgence narrative that's gaining momentum among core audiences and represents a clear counter-trend story.
The Angle: *Oblivion Remastered Switch 2 sold out on release date, showing appeal of physical games*

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.notebookcheck.net/Oblivion-Remastered-Switch-2-sold-out-on-release-date-showing-appeal-of-physical-games.1365878.0.html

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■ *UK scientists growing tiny human organs in the lab*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): UK scientists growing miniature human organs for drug testing has obvious human interest and biotech breakthrough potential with clear near-term applications, despite low current engagement.
The Angle: *British researchers are building miniature organs to test new drugs—potentially replacing animal testing and getting medicines to patients faster. It's sci-fi stuff happening right now, and it raises some wild ethical questions about what we're actually creating.*

- **UK scientists** are developing **miniature human organs** for pharmaceutical drug testing
- The goal is to replace **animal testing** with lab-grown tissue models
- These tiny organs could **speed up drug approval timelines** and improve safety data

The Gut Check

- If they can grow a kidney the size of a pea in a lab, should we ever test drugs on animals again—or does this technology creep you out?

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.theguardian.com/science/2026/aug/12/organoids-human-organs-cambridge-shift-drug-testing-medicines-animals

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FRANCHISE BANK

WHAT THE FRIDAY: 4 banked (+15 each when found)
- "'Am I Supposed to be a Comedian?': Donald Trump's Bizarre White House Correspondent's Dinner Speech Had Few Laughing" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-26)
- "Don Lemon and sexy Smurf joke make for bizarre scene, and more items from the column" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-29)
- "Phillies game forced into bizarre delay as Trea Turner's face lights up green" (nypost.com, banked 2026-08-05)
- "NYC women's shelter brings cat fights, junkies and bizarre antics to neighborhood near playground https://t.co/khWuUTWRRt https://t.co/HwXL2" (X/Twitter @NYPost, banked 2026-08-13)

THROWBACK THURSDAY: 17 banked (+15 each when found)
- "'Star Trek: Starfleet Academy' Has a Troublemaking New Alien Arriving in Season 2 - Gizmodo" (Gizmodo.com (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-26)
- "Apple TV's Neuromancer poster raises questions about its adaptation of an 'unfilmable' novel - Creative Bloq" (Creative Bloq (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-27)

- "'‘Bold Voice of Contemporary Horror’ Comic-Con Panelists Predict the Four Biggest Upcoming Trends in Genre Filmmaking" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-27)
- "'Everybody Loves Raymond' star Patricia Heaton backs calls to ban Mayor Zohran Mamdani from 9/11 anniversary in NYC https://t.co/UCpYAdZR5o " (X/Twitter @NYPost, banked 2026-07-29)
- "Boy George Drops Out of ‘Jesus Christ Superstar’ After Pro-Israel Song Release - Rolling Stone" (Rolling Stone (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-31)
- "'‘Sunday in the Park with George’ Producers Confirm Summer 2027 Show Will Go On ‘As Planned’ After Ariana Grande Exits" (variety.com, banked 2026-08-03)
- "Nordstrom Anniversary Sale Ends Soon — 27 Steals From Hollywood’s Most-Loved Labels" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-08-03)
- "Rosie O’Donnell’s ‘The View’ reunion comments spark alumni meltdown over invites" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-08-04)
- "Anniversary of capybaras escaping High Park inspires video game - ctvnews.ca" (CTV News (via Google News), banked 2026-08-05)
- "Jake T. Austin Says He Wasn’t Invited to Partake in ‘Wizards of Waverly Place’ Revival: “Disappointed”" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-08-07)
- "Japan commemorates 81st anniversary of the atomic bombing of Nagasaki - ctvnews.ca" (CTV News (via Google News), banked 2026-08-09)
- "Where to Watch ‘Real Housewives Ultimate Girls Trip: Roaring 20th’ Anniversary Series Online" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-08-09)
- "Animal Justice holds one year anniversary rally at St. Joseph's Hospital" (CTV News (via Google News), banked 2026-08-10)
- "“Roseanne” Child Star Michael Fishman Slams Idea That the Show’s Revival Was Unjustly Canceled: ‘Words Have Consequences’ - Yahoo" (PEOPLE (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-08-11)
- "Lee Daniels, Nadine Labaki, Marina Abramovic Win Liberatum Pioneer Awards (Exclusive)" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-08-12)
- "Chip Gaines Makes Rare Appearance with Wife Joanna on Magnolia Journal’s Milestone 10th Anniversary Cover - People.com" (People (via Google News), banked 2026-08-14)
- "'‘Cause we (still) rock! The Jonas Brothers introduce a new generation in nostalgia-filled Camp Rock 3 (exclusive)" (Entertainment Weekly (via Google News), banked 2026-08-14)

Newly banked this run:
- THROWBACK THURSDAY: "'‘Cause we (still) rock! The Jonas Brothers introduce a new generation in nostalgia-filled Camp Rock 3 (exclusive)"

SOURCES SKIPPED THIS RUN:

- @WomenBeingAwful (fetch failed)
- @EdNewtonRex (fetch failed)
- @CBCNews (fetch failed)
- @globalnews (fetch failed)
- @Gizmodo (no posts cleared the 30+ likes bar - 5 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- Morning Brew (OpenCLI browser-scrape returned nothing - check Chrome/bridge)
- 20 story(ies) removed after slotting (content-safety and/or not-significant-enough for THE LIST/TRENDING TODAY; automatically backfilled where possible; see run log)

Scout Report Generated: 2026-08-14 09:17 AM